

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Tech That Refuses to Die

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	Until recently, Japan's government stored _____ on floppy disks.
2	An older design may be kept when it _____.
3	A night there lasts about _____ in complete darkness.
4	The rover could draw power from _____ during the long nights.
5	This power source was meant to support its _____ through those nights.
6	Its clockwork mechanism contains _____.
7	Countries use different plugs; it would be better to _____ their designs.
8	Making such a change would require considerable _____.
9	QWERTY may limit _____ compared with another keyboard layout.
10	Court reporters can work much faster with _____.

11 **What central point do the opening examples make about old technology?**

- A Older devices usually return once their prices fall.
- B Older devices can remain useful despite rapid change.
- C Older devices survive mainly as private collections.
- D Older devices are always preferred by institutions.

12 **What two possible reasons are given for the survival of old technology?**

- A It may be cheaper to make, or easier to dispose of.
- B It may be legally required, or difficult to repair.
- C People may love it, or it may still work well.
- D People may collect it, or it may type faster.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **How is HAR-V described when it is introduced?**
- A A mechanical rover built for harsh conditions.
 - B An electronic rover built for easy repairs.
 - C A specialised keyboard built for fast records.
 - D A storage device built for official records.
- 14 **Why was wind power included in the Venus rover concept?**
- A To help the rover avoid the planet's strong winds.
 - B To shorten the period of darkness on Venus.
 - C To replace a damaged electrical plug system.
 - D To help the rover survive Venus's long, hot nights.
- 15 **What makes clockwork a suitable choice for the Venus rover?**
- A It can record information more precisely than electronics.
 - B It can work where ordinary electronics would fail.
 - C It can make the planet's extreme heat disappear.
 - D It can be operated by a court reporter remotely.
- 16 **What is the obstacle to using the same electrical plugs worldwide?**
- A Changing the different systems would take substantial work.
 - B Standard plugs would make appliances less efficient.
 - C Most countries have already rejected electrical plugs.
 - D A common design would prevent new devices being made.
- 17 **What limitation of QWERTY is raised in the discussion?**
- A Its keys are difficult to recognise by sight.
 - B Its layout cannot be used for exact records.
 - C Its layout may be less efficient for fast typing.
 - D Its design can only be used on typewriters.
- 18 **What does the curator's response imply about the speed advantage of specialist keyboards?**
- A It will persuade most everyday users to change immediately.
 - B It exists only when reporters use a QWERTY layout.
 - C It is too small to be useful in any recording work.
 - D It does not outweigh the effort of learning them for her.

19 **Why are court reporters used as an example?**

- A They show that another keyboard can support faster exact transcription.
- B They show that official records are still stored on floppy disks.
- C They show that QWERTY has become the fastest keyboard layout.
- D They show that mechanical devices can survive extreme heat.

20 **What broader conclusion does the continued use of QWERTY support?**

- A The oldest design will eventually become the most efficient.
- B A technical disadvantage always forces a rapid change.
- C Familiarity can preserve a system despite better alternatives.
- D Specialist tools will soon replace everyday keyboards.